

For details on how to get forms and publications, see the instructions for the 2025 Form 1040 and 1040-SR.

What's New

In figuring your 2026 estimated tax, be sure to consider the following.

Standard deduction amount increased. For 2026, the standard deduction amount has been increased for all filers. If you don't itemize your deductions, you can take the 2026 standard deduction listed in the following chart for your filing status.

IF your 2026 filing status is...	THEN your standard deduction is...
Married filing jointly or Qualifying surviving spouse	\$32,200
Head of household	\$24,150
Single or Married filing separately	\$16,100

However, if you can be claimed as a dependent on another person's 2026 return, your standard deduction is the greater of:

- \$1,350, or
- Your earned income plus \$450 (up to the standard deduction amount).

Your standard deduction is increased by the following amount if, at the end of 2026, you are:

- An unmarried individual (single or head of household) and are:

65 or older or blind	\$2,050
65 or older and blind	\$4,100

- A married individual (filing jointly or separately) or a qualifying surviving spouse and are:

65 or older or blind	\$1,650
65 or older and blind	\$3,300
Both spouses 65 or older	\$3,300*
Both spouses 65 or older and blind	\$6,600*

* Only if married filing jointly. If married filing separately, these amounts do not apply.



CAUTION Your standard deduction is zero if (a) your spouse itemizes on a separate return, or (b) you were a dual-status alien and you do not elect to be taxed as a resident alien for 2026.

Social security tax. For 2026, the maximum amount of earned income (wages and net earnings from self-employment) subject to the social security tax is \$184,500.

Additional child tax credit amount. For 2026, the maximum additional child tax credit amount is \$1,700 for each qualifying child.

Adoption credit or exclusion. For 2026, the maximum adoption credit or exclusion for employer-provided adoption benefits has increased to \$17,670. In order to

claim either the credit or exclusion, your modified adjusted gross income must be less than \$305,080. For 2026, up to \$5,120 of the adoption credit is now refundable. The refundable portion is determined per child.

Changes to QBID. Recent legislation made the qualified business income deduction (QBID) permanent. In addition, beginning in 2026, if you have a minimum of \$1,000 in total qualified business income from an active trade or business, you may be able to claim a minimum QBID of \$400. Also, the phase-in range for taxpayers who are married filing jointly will increase to \$150,000 and to \$75,000 for all other filing statuses.

Casualty loss deduction made permanent and expanded. The deduction for certain personal casualty losses has been made permanent. In addition, beginning in 2026, a personal casualty loss deduction can also include losses associated with a state-declared disaster. For more information, see the Instructions for Form 4684 and Pub. 547.

Deduction for educator expenses. Beginning in 2026, if you are an eligible educator with qualifying expenses, you may be able to claim a deduction for those expenses on Form 1040, Schedule 1, as well as an itemized deduction on Schedule A (Form 1040). You will take the deduction on Schedule 1 (Form 1040) and then determine the amount of any itemized deduction you can take on Schedule A. The type of expenses that qualify for each deduction is slightly different.

Limit on itemized deductions. For 2026, your overall itemized deductions may be reduced. If your taxable income is more than the following amounts, your itemized deductions will be reduced by 5.4% of the lesser of (1) your total itemized deductions or (2) the amount your taxable income is more than the following amounts.

- \$768,700 if Married filing jointly or Qualifying surviving spouse,
- \$640,600 if Head of household or Single, or
- \$384,350 if Married filing separately.

The limitation will be applied after any other applicable limitations on your itemized deductions and will not apply when figuring any QBID.

Moving expense deduction for members of the intelligence community. Beginning in 2026, in addition to members of the Armed Forces, members of the intelligence community may be able to deduct their moving expenses on Schedule 1 (Form 1040). For more information, see the instructions for Schedule 1 (Form 1040).

Limitation on deductible gambling losses. Beginning in 2026, your gambling loss deduction on Schedule A (Form 1040) will be limited to 90% of your gambling winnings.

Changes to the child and dependent care credit. For 2026, recent legislation has enhanced the credit for qualifying child and dependent care expenses paid for the care of an eligible child. The credit amount remains \$3,000 (\$6,000 for two or more qualifying children) but the maximum credit rate has increased from 35% to 50% of your qualifying expenses.